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### B. Functions of Retailers

1. **Buying**: A retailer buys a wide variety of goods from different wholesalers after estimating customer's demand. He selects the best merchandise from each wholesaler and brings all the goods under one roof. So, he performs the twin functions of buying and assembling of goods.
2. **Storage:** A retailer maintains a ready stock of goods and displays them in the shop.
3. **Selling:** The retailer sells the goods in small quantities according to the demand taste and preference of consumers. He employs efficient methods of selling to increase his sales turnover.
4. **Grading and Packing:** The retailer grades the goods which are not graded by manufacturers and wholesalers. He packs goods in small lots for the convenience of consumers
5. **Risk-bearing:** A retailer always keeps stock of goods in anticipation of demand and bears the risk of loss due to fire, theft, spoilage, price fluctuations, etc.
6. **Transportation:** Retailers often carry goods from manufacturers to their retail outlets.
7. **Financing:** Some retailers grant credit facilities to his customers and provide the facility of return or exchange of goods. Door delivery and after sale service are provided by retailers

### C. Services Rendered by Retailers

The following are the services rendered by the retailers.

#### Services to Manufacturers and Wholesalers

Retailers provide the following services to manufacturers and wholesalers.

1. **Help in Distribution** Retailers relieve the manufacturers and wholesalers of the burden of collecting and executing a large number of small orders from various consumers.
2. **Market Information** Retailer supply valuable information to wholesalers about changes in tastes, preferences, fashion etc. of consumers
3. **Large Scale Operation** The manufacturers and wholesalers are freed from the trouble of making individual sales to consumers in small quantities. This enables them to operate on, at relatively large scale and thereby fully concentrate on their other activities
4. **Help in Promotion** Retailers participate in the promotional activities carried by manufacturers and wholesalers such as short time offers, coupons, free gifts, sales contests, etc. Retailers help in promoting the sale of the products.